altairsim — Altair Disk Extended BASIC 4.1 on an 8" floppy

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altairsim diskbasic.toml

MEMORY SIZE?
LINEPRINTER? C
HIGHEST DISK NUMBER? 0
HOW MANY FILES?
HOW MANY RANDOM FILES?

37033 BYTES FREE
ALTAIR BASIC REV. 4.1
[DISK EXTENDED VERSION]
COPYRIGHT 1977 BY MITS INC.
OK
```

Altair BASIC Rev 4.1, Disk Extended Version (MITS, 1977) on an 8" Pertec FD-400 behind an 88-DCDD, booted by the DBL PROM at `FF00` — `RUN FF00` is the machine file's whole startup, because on a real disk Altair that was EXAMINE `FF00` and RUN.

Unlike the cassette BASIC in `../basic`, this one has a filesystem: files, a directory, `SAVE` by name, and the `DSKINI` command.

`^E` (ATTN) takes the keyboard back to the monitor at any point; `RUN` resumes.

The startup dialogue, because one question has no guessable answer

Question	Answer
`MEMORY SIZE?`	Return — take all of it
`LINEPRINTER?`	**`C`** — and only `C`, `O` or `Q` are accepted
`HIGHEST DISK NUMBER?`	`0` — one drive, numbered from zero
`HOW MANY FILES?`	Return
`HOW MANY RANDOM FILES?`	Return

`LINEPRINTER?` re-asks in silence on anything it does not like — no error, no hint. Answer it with a blank line or an `N` and the prompt comes straight back, which looks like a hung machine and is not one. `C` is the 88-C700 line printer, and it is legal here even though this machine has no printer board: the answer only tells BASIC where `LPRINT` should go, and nothing is written until you use it. Fit an 88-C700 if you want it to land somewhere — `altairsim -x 'SHOW MACHINE' lineprinter` has one already wired up.

The answer set is Rev 4.1's own; MITS's *Basic Versions* table, kept with the sources under `disks/mits-88dcdd/diskbasic/`, is where it is written down.

The files

File	What it is
`diskbasic.toml`	The machine: `base = "default"` plus the floppy in drive 0.
`Disk BASIC 4.1.dsk`	The bootable system disk.

There is no undo. Drive 0 is mounted read/write because that is what a real machine is, and `SAVE` and `DSKINI` both write. In a clone `git checkout` puts the image back; in the package you were handed, nothing does. Copy it first if you are about to experiment in anger.

The filename has spaces in it, which is authentic and occasionally inconvenient: quote it anywhere you type it, or `MOUNT` reads `BASIC` as an option and refuses.

Three drives are empty. `MOUNT dsk0:drive1 "my-data.dsk"` fills one — and raise the answer to `HIGHEST DISK NUMBER?` to let BASIC see it.